

LEVEL 1 • TERM 1 • LESSON 8 • FOR PARENTS

8 Balance and Swap

WHAT WE DID

We learned that the equals sign means 'the same amount as', like a balanced see-saw. Your child balanced two plates of small things and found missing numbers like 6 + 3 = 5 + ___. Give and take: when one number goes up, the other goes down by the same amount. Term 1 goes beyond the school Primary 1 syllabus on purpose, so some sums have tens; we explore them with objects first.

> **Adjust one side, adjust the other. When one number goes up, the other goes down by the same amount.**

TRY AT HOME (5 MINUTES)

1. Two plates: put a pile of buttons on each plate (7 on the left, 5 on the right). Ask: are they the same? Move one across and count again.
2. Say it: write 8 + 5 = 9 + ___ and ask your child to say how the 8 moved and what that means for the 5.
3. Make a mistake on purpose: write 7 + 3 = 8 + 3 and ask your child to find what is wrong and fix it.

When your child is stuck

Let your child use two plates and small things or draw the two sides, and wait 10 seconds before helping. Please do not teach the column method yet, and do not hurry. If your child ticked I am still stuck on the look-back page, photograph that page and send it to the business WhatsApp, +65 9880 5962, after class. Photos are kept for 90 days after the program ends, then deleted.

Words we used

- equals (=): the two sides are the same amount
- balance: both sides hold the same
- give and take: add some to one number and take the same from the other
- blank: the line where the missing number goes

Good questions

- How do you know?
- Did the first number go up or down?
- What must the other number do?

Have ready for next lesson

- A ruler marked in centimetres, starting at 0 (a pencil-case ruler is fine; no ruler? tell your tutor)
- 10 paper clips (or small same-size things) and 3 or 4 things to measure
- The printed Lesson 9 workbook (print at 100%, actual size), a pencil and spare paper

Next lesson

Lesson 9: Draw and Measure. The recording has the tutor, the shared screen and any voice that is not muted; your child may mute and keep the camera off. The recording link is private to your family: please do not share it. Missed a lesson? Every lesson is recorded; your tutor will share a private link with enrolled families.